

EASTER FOOLS

INTRO: Welcome to Easter Fools Day!
Rarely does a thing like this happen that Easter and April Fools day fall on the same day! In fact, the last time this occurred was in 1956 and it will not recur again until 2029 and then in 2040. 2040 will be the last time this will occur in this century! Since this happens so rarely I could not resist the temptation to marry the two ideas together.

If you feel I am being sacrilegious you need to lighten up so the stress of this world won't kill you before your time!

April Fools Day is all about a joke!

- On April 1, 2016 Cottonelle Corporation Tweeted they were about to introduce left-handed toilet paper...
- On April 1, 1996 Taco Bell ran an ad purporting to have purchased the Liberty

Bell for \$50,000 in an effort to help relieve the national debt...

- On April 1, 1962 the Swedish National Network ran a TV spot featuring an expert who reported that it's black and white broadcasts could be seen in color by viewing the TV set through nylon stockings...

(My greatest April Fools joke ever was played on staff!)

Easter is not funny, right? Easter is serious stuff so how can we marry the two thoughts together? Just hang with me as I guide you through this...

That first Easter dawned bright and early in the Garden Tomb outside Jerusalem:

- Jesus had been murdered at the hands of wicked and cruel men and a religious system run amuck...
- His body had been laid in a borrowed

- tomb on the outskirts of Jerusalem, not far from where He had been crucified...
- The disciples were so grief stricken that they were invisible at the cross...
 - The women were reluctantly making their way to the cemetery...
 - The women encountered two angels that let them know that Jesus was not dead but alive...
 - Mary Magdalene was so distraught that she didn't even recognize Him, supposing Him to be the gardener...

It is neither a stretch nor a slight to say that the resurrection was a joke—and a very good one at that!!! What better way could Jesus have mocked a world who had brutally murdered Him than to rise from the dead?

The resurrection was the perfect joke at the expense of those who wanted Jesus dead!

Fool = Someone who is unwise, lacks good sense and judgment.

I. THE FOOL HAS SAID IN HIS HEART THERE IS NO GOD...

Psalm 53:1 (NKJV) *“The fool has said in his heart, “There is no God.” They are corrupt, and have done abominable iniquity; There is none who does good.”*

Notice the Scripture does not state that the fool said these words out loud but has said, *“in his heart, there is no God.”*

There are only 450 – 500 million atheists in the world today! There are more than seven billion people on the earth so less than 7% of the world’s population identify themselves as atheists. (We live in a world full of Gods)

Probably no one in this room would place themselves in the atheist category this morning but look at what the Bible say’s:

“The fool has said in his heart, there is no God...” People who live as if there is no God: (Psalm 53:1)

- Are corrupt... (Think nothing of participating in acts of corruption – Sorry they got caught, not for what they did)
- Do abominable things... (Idolatry – Condemning the just – Adultery - Homosexuality – Sacrifices of the wicked – A proud look – A lying tongue – An unjust balance or scale – The Bible lists 57 things that are an abomination to the Lord)
- Commit iniquity... Iniquity means to bend, make crooked or pervert. This is making wrong right and right wrong. This is the spirit of the age.

You do not have to verbalize the words that there is no God in order to be a fool. If you embrace the aforementioned lifestyle you are ***“A fool who has said in his heart, there***

is no God.” It is possible for one to say they believe in God or that they are a follower of Christ, yet, their lifestyle say’s something completely different.

Are you a “*Fool who has said in his heart, there is no God?*”

II. THE DEVIL AND HIS CRONIES WERE FOOLS FOR HAVING JESUS CRUCIFIED...

I Corinthians 2:14 (NKJV) “*The natural man does not receive the things of the Spirit of God, for they are foolishness to him; nor can he know them, because they are spiritually discerned.*”

1 Corinthians 2:6-8 (NKJV) “*We speak wisdom among those who are mature, yet not the wisdom of this age, nor of the rulers of this age, who are coming to nothing. 7 But we speak the wisdom of God in a mystery, the hidden wisdom which God*

ordained before the ages for our glory, & which none of the rulers of this age knew; for had they known, they would not have crucified the Lord of glory.”

Trust me, the devil knew exactly who he was crucifying! No one knows who Jesus is better than the devil!

According to the Apostle Paul the wisest men of Jesus day did not know who they were crucifying! Why? Because they were fools!

The devil proved himself to be a fool by inciting the crowd to crucify Jesus in spite of the fact he knew exactly who Jesus was, and knew every prophecy of his resurrection!

Why would he do such a thing? Because his foolishness convinced him that he could prevent the resurrection from happening!

What a fool! This was no doubt the greatest miscalculation of all time!

The smartest men and religious leaders of Jesus day proved themselves to be mere fools by not recognizing who Jesus was despite all of the prophecies He fulfilled through:

- His virgin birth...
- Sinless life...
- Substitutionary death...
- Unprecedented resurrection...
- Very public ascension...

What fools! Yet there are people sitting in this very room today that are taking equally foolish actions by not accepting Jesus as the savior of their lives and following His Bible as the roadmap for their lives!

III. EASTER FOOLS...

In 1 Corinthians 4:10 the Apostle Paul states that ***“We are fools for Christ sake.”***

An Easter fool is a person who has been forgiven of his/her sins and sold out to the idea of following Christ! No matter what!

An Easter Fool believes:

- Jesus is God... I MUST BE AN EASTER FOOL!
- The Virgin Mary gave birth to the Son of God... I MUST BE AN EASTER FOOL!
- Jesus lived 33 ½ years, was in all points tempted as we are and did not sin once... I MUST BE AN EASTER FOOL!
- Jesus death on the cross is the fix for the sinful condition of the human race... I MUST BE AN EASTER FOOL!
- On the third day Jesus arose from the grave, victorious over death, hell and the grave... I MUST BE AN EASTER FOOL!
- He ascended from Bethany's launching pad... I MUST BE AN EASTER FOOL!

- His return is imminent... I MUST BE AN EASTER FOOL!

1 Corinthians 1:18 (KJV) *“For the preaching of the cross is to them that perish foolishness; but unto us which are saved it is the power of God.”*

I MUST BE AN EASTER FOOL!!!